

Becoming an Agentic Scrum Master

Handing my glue-work to agents

Eli Kent, SSW

SSW October User Group | Melbourne | 21 Oct 2026

Agents took my glue-work, so I have more time for the team.

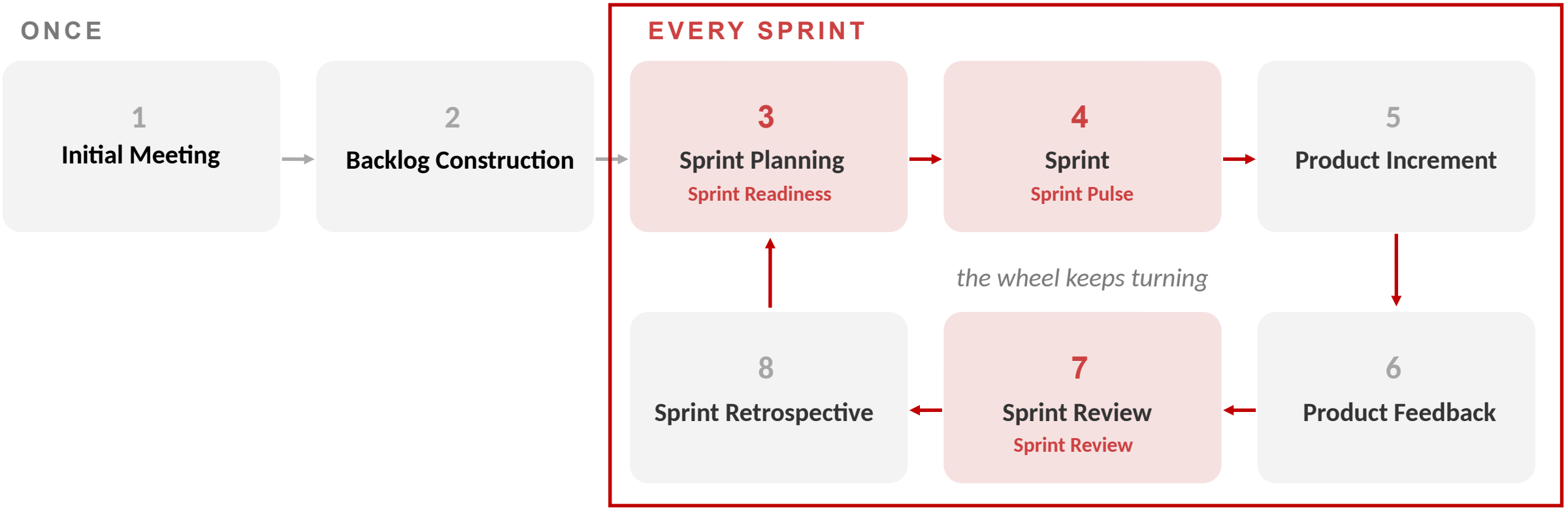
40%

Glue-work, now done by agents

60%

Time with the team

The 8 Steps to Scrum



Red: where today's three demos live.

Source: SSW Rules, The 8 Steps to Scrum

My week, before agents

- Prepping the sprint review and retro
- Chasing PBIs and keeping the board up to date
- Writing up what got done, and what is next
- Triaging the same community question again
- Poking the same dashboards for the same problems

Glue-work

Small jobs that keep the sprint moving.

They add up to hours a week.

Agents do the busywork now.
I just check their work.

Three things make it work

1

Skills

Repeatable playbooks.
A skill is a markdown file.

2

Routines

A skill that runs on a schedule.

3

MCP tools

Reach into GitHub, PostHog, chat and the board.

The more an agent can change, the closer I watch it.

- Read-only agents can run safely overnight.
- An agent that writes, waits for my OK.

Three demos, one sprint

		WHEN	WHAT THE AGENT DOES	IMPACT	WHERE I SIT
1	**Sprint Readiness**	Before planning	Proposes changes to the backlog	**Highest**	**I click accept**
2	**Sprint Pulse**	Every morning	Reads, tells me what changed	**Lowest**	**Asleep**
3	**Sprint Review**	End of sprint	Drafts the whole write-up	**Middle**	**The editor**

1 Sprint Readiness

Backlog Refinery, the app I built

Ready has a definition

SSW's Definition of Ready

Enough detail to action (acceptance criteria) With evidence from the code and PostHog	**The agent drafts it**
Business value assigned From PostHog usage, with a priority	**The agent drafts it**
Effort assigned	**The agent drafts it**
Approved	**My click**

Source: SSW Rules, Do you have a Definition of Ready?

Needs Triage: what nobody works through

Needs Triage: no estimate, no acceptance criteria, half of it already done.

300+ → **<100**

issues stuck in ‘Needs Triage’

issues remaining - worked down one at a time

Who knows the difference between System 1 and System 2?

Put your hand up if you could explain it.

System 1 and System 2

Jev scores each new issue as it opens. Claude does the slow reading.

SYSTEM 1

Jev

typesafe.ai, in GitHub Actions

- Every new TinaCMS issue, as it opens
- Flags likely duplicates
- Picks the label (shadow mode for now)
- Acts only when it is confident

SYSTEM 2

Claude

Backlog Refinery, one item at a time

- Checks the issue against the code
- Drafts the estimate and the criteria
- Shows its evidence
- I accept or skip every one

After Daniel Kahneman, Thinking, Fast and Slow

Demo: one item at a time



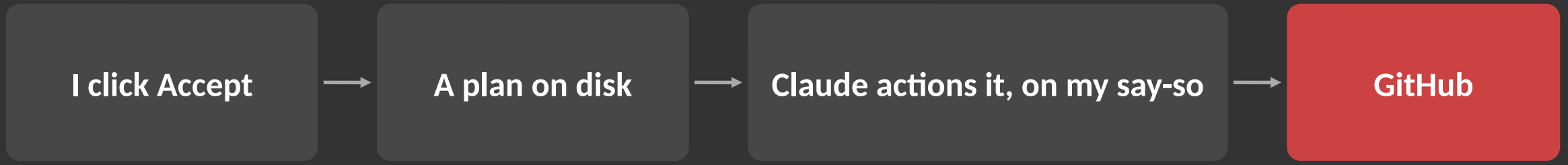
A real card from the app

Each item arrives with a draft:

- An estimate
- A priority, from PostHog usage
- A new title or body
- Close it, split it, or check the code first

I edit it, then **accept or skip** it.

The app never touches GitHub



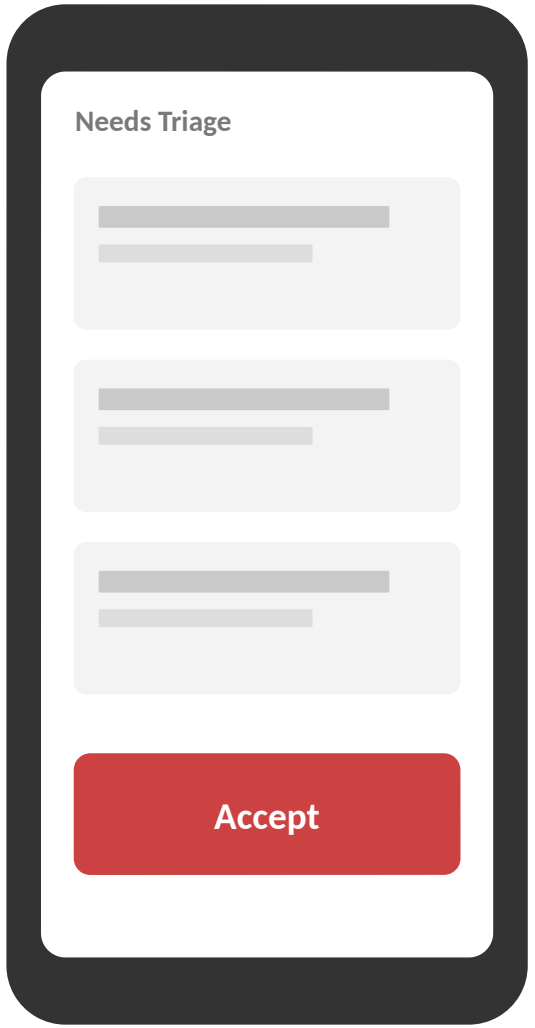
Claude shows me anything public before it posts.

This app can change the most, so I approve each write.

It works from my phone

- Runs on a launchd server, reachable over Tailscale.
- I triage the backlog from the couch, on my phone.
- **Claude actions it on a schedule.**

tailscale



2 Sprint Pulse

The routine that reads

The morning check

Every weekday morning, without me:

1. **The board**
   What moved, and what did not
2. **Reviews**
   PRs waiting too long on a review
3. **The bench**
   Who is on leave or booked to a client this sprint
4. **CI**
   Red on main

I only hear from it **when something needs me.**

Who is on the project, day by day

	Wed	Thu	Fri	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri
Dev A	C	C	C	in	in	C	C	C
Dev B	C	C	C	C	C	C	C	C
Dev C	in	C	C	C	C	C	C	C
Dev D	in	in	in	in	off	in	off	in
Dev E	off	in	in	off	off	off	in	in
Dev F	in	in	in	L	in	in	in	in

in on the project

C client

L leave or holiday

off not a project day

Example from the pulse, names removed

- Each morning it reads client bookings and leave from Power BI, through my Chrome.
- It knows which state each person is in for public holidays, and who works part-time on the project.

What it changes in the sprint

Sprint Planning

I forecast from the days each person is on the project, so the sprint fits the team we have.

During the sprint

When someone gets booked to a client, it lists the work they hold and who is free to take it.

LEAVING THE SPRINT

Dev C - on client in 1 day, holds 9 pts

Partner Program	In progress	**2**
Hard breaks dropped	In review	**2**
Partners Page	In review	**1**
Capture churn feedback	Backlog	**4**

Free to take it: Dev F now, Dev E from Thursday

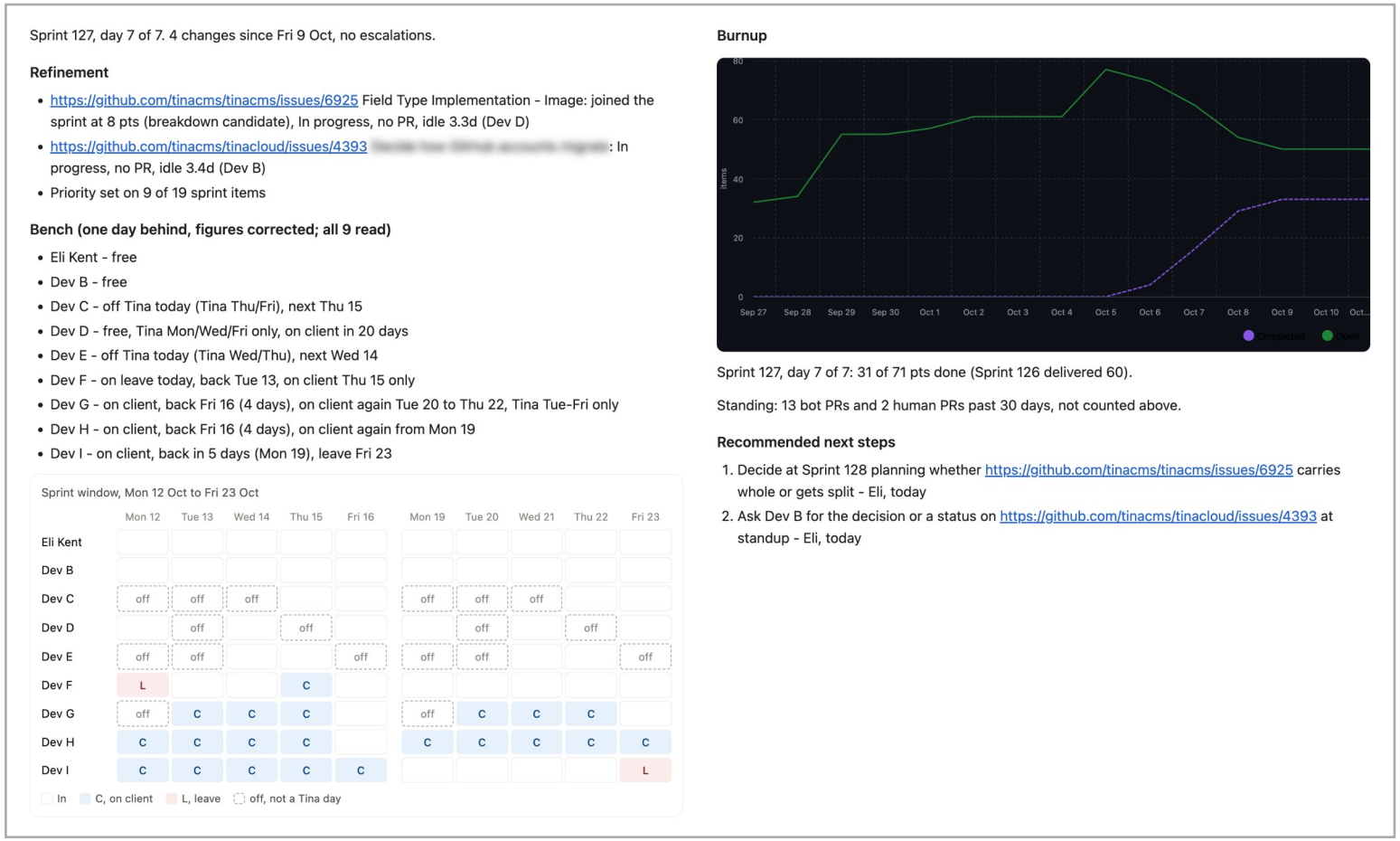
Example from the pulse, names removed

Demo: the morning report

7am

every weekday, as a Claude task

- Diffs against yesterday
- Silent when nothing changed
- Opens Chrome to read the Power BI bench



Sprint 127, day 7 of 7. 4 changes since Fri 9 Oct, no escalations.

Refinement

- https://github.com/tinacms/tinacms/issues/6925 Field Type Implementation - Image: joined the sprint at 8 pts (breakdown candidate), In progress, no PR, idle 3.3d (Dev D)
- https://github.com/tinacms/tinacloud/issues/4393 [redacted]: In progress, no PR, idle 3.4d (Dev B)
- Priority set on 9 of 19 sprint items

Bench (one day behind, figures corrected; all 9 read)

- Eli Kent - free
- Dev B - free
- Dev C - off Tina today (Tina Thu/Fri), next Thu 15
- Dev D - free, Tina Mon/Wed/Fri only, on client in 20 days
- Dev E - off Tina today (Tina Wed/Thu), next Wed 14
- Dev F - on leave today, back Tue 13, on client Thu 15 only
- Dev G - on client, back Fri 16 (4 days), on client again Tue 20 to Thu 22, Tina Tue-Fri only
- Dev H - on client, back Fri 16 (4 days), on client again from Mon 19
- Dev I - on client, back in 5 days (Mon 19), leave Fri 23

Sprint window, Mon 12 Oct to Fri 23 Oct

	Mon 12	Tue 13	Wed 14	Thu 15	Fri 16	Mon 19	Tue 20	Wed 21	Thu 22	Fri 23
Eli Kent										
Dev B										
Dev C	off	off	off			off	off	off		
Dev D		off		off			off		off	
Dev E	off	off			off	off	off			off
Dev F	L			C						
Dev G	off	C	C	C		off	C	C	C	
Dev H	C	C	C	C		C	C	C	C	C
Dev I	C	C	C	C	C					L

In · C, on client · L, leave · off, not a Tina day

Burnup

Sprint 127, day 7 of 7: 31 of 71 pts done (Sprint 126 delivered 60).

Standing: 13 bot PRs and 2 human PRs past 30 days, not counted above.

Recommended next steps

1. Decide at Sprint 128 planning whether https://github.com/tinacms/tinacms/issues/6925 carries whole or gets split - Eli, today
2. Ask Dev B for the decision or a status on https://github.com/tinacms/tinacloud/issues/4393 at standup - Eli, today

The pulse from Mon 12 Oct, names removed

3 Sprint Review

The routine that drafts

Review day used to be my morning

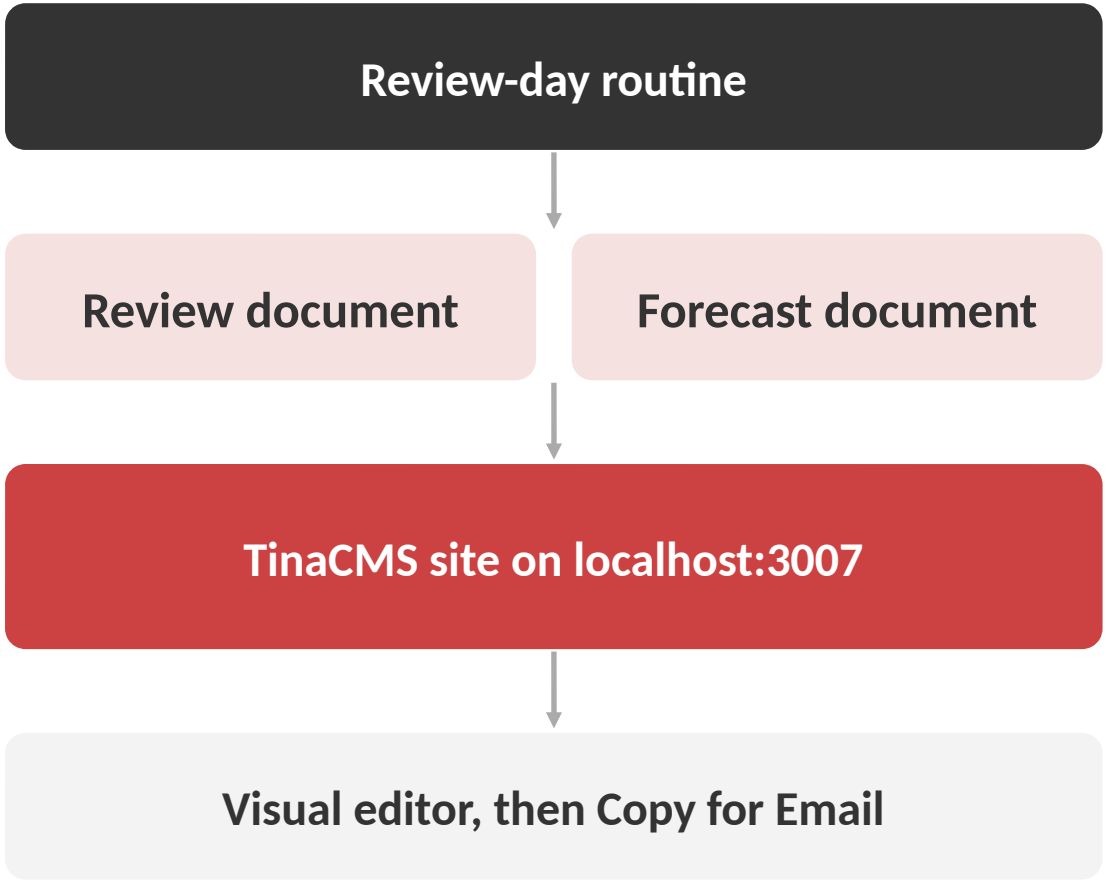
1. Pull the numbers from six dashboards
2. Screenshot every chart
3. Write up what shipped, and what is next
4. Format it twice: review and forecast

I did all of this by hand, every sprint.

It writes into tinacms

The site is built with our own product.

The routine writes the review and the forecast in as documents, ready to edit.



Demo: the review page

6

dashboards, pulled live

- **GitHub**
- **PostHog**
- **Power BI**
- **CloudWatch**
- **The board**
- **Tina tracker**

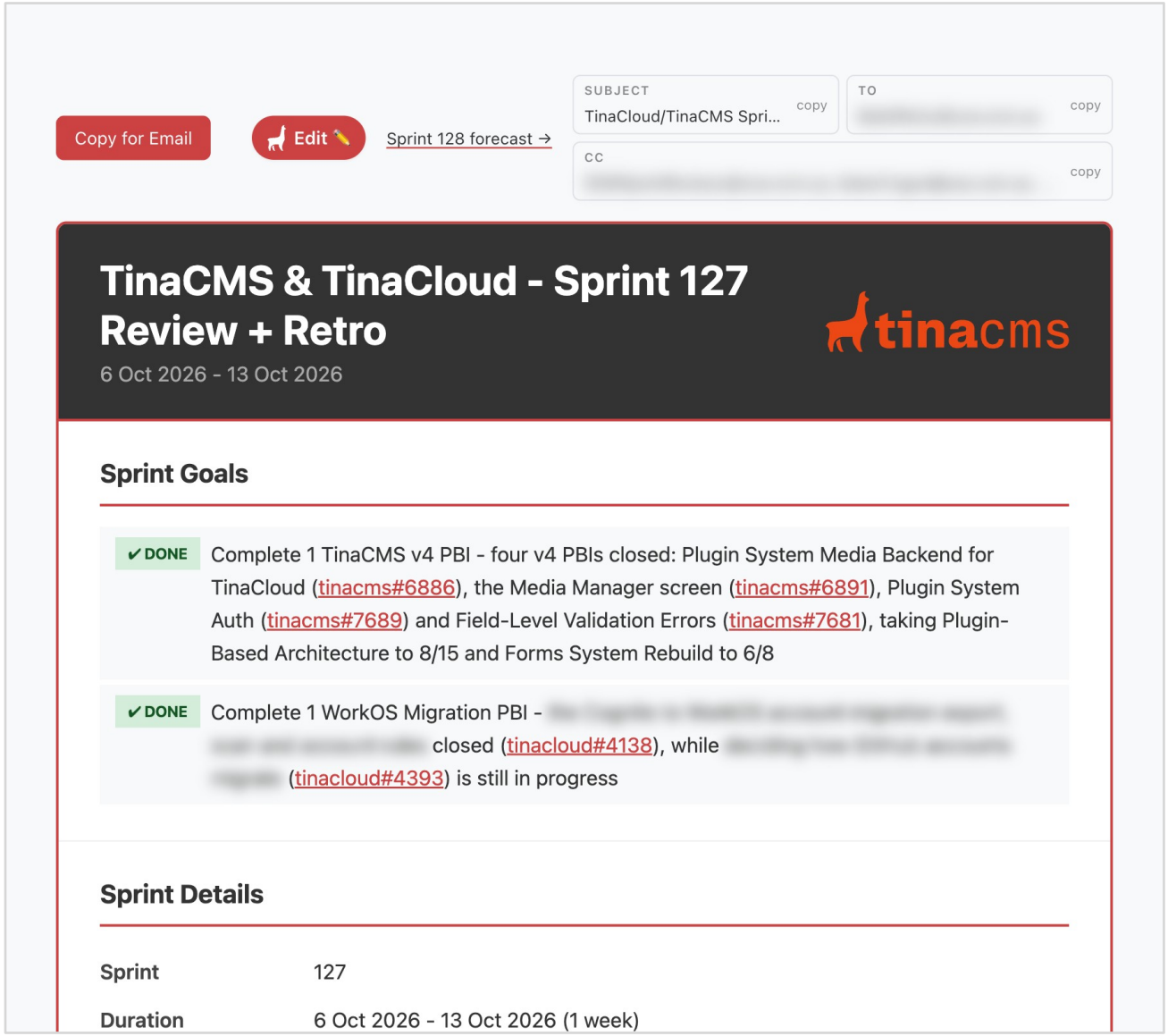
The page **is** the email: I press Copy for Email.

What it wrote

Sprint 127

the real review, written on review day

- Built by the routine, unattended
- Edit in TinaCMS opens this page
- Copy for Email makes it the email



The real page, Sprint 127, localhost:3007

It drafts. I edit in TinaCMS. I send.



Never emails anyone

Shape it in the visual editor

The words are mine

Nothing goes out under my name until I send it.

I still facilitate, make the calls and look after the team.

Agents do the glue-work.
And I run the Scrum.

What we covered

1

Sprint Readiness

It drafts each backlog item. I accept or skip it.

2

Sprint Pulse

It reads the board and the bench each morning. It tells me who is on and what changed.

3

Sprint Review

It drafts the review in TinaCMS. I edit it and send it.

The more an agent can change, the closer I watch it.

Start on Monday

1. Pick the most boring thing you do
2. Write down the steps you already follow
3. Save it as a skill, and run it read-only first
4. Give it a schedule. Let it write last, behind a review.

Resources



The skills, Backlog Refinery and these slides.

github.com/kulesy/agentic-scrum-master-kit

Happy to keep talking afterwards.

Thank you

Questions?

Eli Kent, SSW



Feedback

Scan to rate this talk.

Point your phone camera at the code.

